NODAL POINT // CALL BRIEF

DUNCANVILLE ISD ENERGY MEMO

Prepared from the March 31, 2026 call with Marqeis Scott in Purchasing.

DISTRICT CONTACT
Marqeis Scott
Purchasing, Duncanville ISD
Current supplier: Reliant

BOARD-READY SUMMARY

The renewal date is not the risk. Summer peak demand is.

WHAT THE CALL TOLD US

Marqeis said the district is still under contract and is **not planning to move immediately**. That is the right answer for procurement. It is not the right answer for bill visibility. The district should use the window now to understand whether there is a **demand ratchet**, a peak-demand rider, or summer load behavior that could carry cost forward even before the contract ends.

Key point. We are not asking Duncanville ISD to switch contracts today. We are asking for the latest bill and enough detail to see whether the current structure is already creating unnecessary pressure on the budget.

Districts usually start looking 6 to 8 months before expiration. That is the right time to compare options. It is also the right time to verify what the bill is doing right now.

TIMING CUE FROM THE CALL

ACCOUNT FACTS

CONTACT
Marqeis Scott
Purchasing for Duncanville ISD.

CURRENT SUPPLIER
Reliant
District is still mid-contract.

PLANNING WINDOW
6 to 8 months
That is when they start shopping.

RISK TO VERIFY
Demand ratchet
One hot summer peak can set a higher billing floor for the rest of the year.

POTENTIAL DEMAND SHAPE — SUMMER IS THE PRESSURE POINT

Plain English: one summer spike can set a higher billing floor, so later months can cost more even when usage drops.

WHY WAITING IS RISKY

01 **Contract timing does not erase billing risk.**
The district can stay inside its current agreement and still carry a costly peak-demand pattern on the bill.

02 **Demand ratchet, in plain English.**
One hot summer peak can set the billing floor. After that, the district can keep paying against that higher number even when usage drops.

03 **Summer load is still the trigger.**
Cooling several campuses at once can push peak demand up even when day-to-day usage looks stable.

WHAT TO SEND NOW

- A recent **Reliant invoice** or bill PDF.
- Any page that shows **contract end** or renewal language.
- Any note on **campus cooling load** or summer schedule changes.
- If available, a meter list so we can check for **peak-demand exposure**.

Best next move. Send the latest bill first. If the bill is clean, great. If it is not, the district will know early enough to plan instead of reacting.

HVAC + BUILDING CONTROLS FOR DUNCANVILLE ISD

District-wide comfort, lower waste, and cleaner operating decisions.

AUDIENCE
Purchasing, chief of staff, and superintendent review
Board-ready summary

OPERATIONAL BRIEF

Controls and HVAC are where the easy savings usually live.

WHY THIS MATTERS TO A SCHOOL DISTRICT

Comfort is mandatory. Waste is optional.

Duncanville ISD does not need a flashy pitch. It needs a practical way to reduce operating noise across campuses, keep classrooms comfortable, and give leadership a clean story they can stand behind.

Most of the early wins are not in replacement work. They are in **controls, scheduling, setpoints, fault detection, and right-sized equipment decisions** that lower cost while keeping the buildings stable during Texas heat.

> If the district is already planning 6 to 8 months ahead on procurement, now is the time to gather the bill data and identify any HVAC or controls work that should be bundled into the next review cycle.

BUILDING CONTROLS

Smart controls and building automation give Duncanville a way to manage multiple campuses with one operating view instead of chasing issues building by building.

- **Centralized Management:** One dashboard can simplify district operations and keep leadership informed.
- **Automated Savings:** Schedules, resets, and demand limiting can run every day without adding more manual work.
- **Alarms & FDD:** Fault detection helps find comfort or cost problems before they turn into complaints.
- **Open Protocols:** BACnet and Modbus keep the district flexible instead of locked into one narrow system.

HVAC

HVAC is where comfort and cost meet. The goal is not to spend less on the buildings. The goal is to stop paying for wasted run-time, oversized equipment, and poor sequencing.

- **Right-Sized Solutions:** Load analysis helps match equipment to the actual building need.
- **Operational Efficiency:** Better sequences and retro-commissioning cut out avoidable waste.
- **Indoor Air Quality:** Filtration and ventilation upgrades can improve conditions without excess energy use.
- **Lifecycle Value:** Lower operating expense and better control usually extend asset life.

SIMPLE NEXT STEPS FOR DUNCANVILLE ISD

1. Send the latest bill
Use the latest bill so we can check rate, demand, and riders.

2. Flag the demand issue
If a ratchet exists, we want it visible before renewal.

3. Tie in HVAC and controls
Use the review to spot HVAC fixes worth bundling into the next cycle.

REPRESENTATIVE CAMPUS BRIEF

Three representative campuses, one shared operating problem.

REPRESENTATIVE CAMPUSES

Reed Middle School
Duncanville High School
Alexander Elementary

CAMPUS SAMPLE

Representative campuses. One shared summer pressure.

REED MIDDLE SCHOOL

DUNCANVILLE HIGH SCHOOL

ALEXANDER ELEMENTARY

These three campuses are a representative sample from a 17-school district. The district is not one building. It is a portfolio. The reason we care about the bill now is simple: the same summer heat that affects comfort also creates peak-demand pressure across multiple campuses.

What the sample shows

Different campuses, different footprints, and different load behavior. That usually means different opportunities hiding in the controls and HVAC strategy.

What the bill can show

If the invoice has a demand ratchet or a peak-demand rider, the district can get hit even before the contract ends.

What to do next

Send the latest bill, verify the rate structure, then decide whether controls or HVAC work belongs in the next review cycle.